FAMILY CARE FIRST | REACT

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Livelihoods assessment of vulnerable households affected by the socio-economic impact of COVID-19, at risk of separation or who have been reintegrated, who are receiving case management

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Acronyms

DCA	Danish Church Aid
FAO	United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization
FCF	Family Care First
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
HES	Household Economic Survey
IPC	Integrated Phase Classification
Kii	Key information interviews
MoLVT	Ministry of Labor and Vocational Training
MoSVY	Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth
PDAFF	Provincial Department of Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery
RGC	Royal Government of Cambodia
SCI	Save the Children International
TVET	National Technical Vocational Education and Training center
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
WFP	World Food Program

Executive Summary

The livelihoods assessment will support the design of a child-sensitive livelihood assistance program to prompt livelihoods restoration and prevent, or reduce, the use of negative coping strategies, which are potentially harmful for children. The program will target the same vulnerable households receiving a child-sensitive cash assistance.

This initiative falls under SCI global agenda that seeks to demystify the risks and opportunities that cash-based assistance may entail to reduce the risks of family separation.

To complete this livelihoods assessment SCI Cambodia led a livelihood desk review, a household economic survey to 823 households already receiving case management services, 5 focus group discussions with 35 social workers and an assessment of 14 training providers.

The results show that the socio-economic situation of already vulnerable households has been further exacerbated with the closure of businesses, increased unemployment, a lower demand in key sectors and the subsequent loss of revenues. Poor and near-poor households are on the rise.

98% of the households experienced a reduction in income as a result of COVID-19 (22% lost all their revenues and 54% a majority of them). A large majority of households have been forced to adopt negative coping strategies, notably to cope with the lack of food, such as the contraction of high levels of debt (often beyond $3,000 when the average monthly income per capita is approximately $104) and adults eating less to ensure food for small children. As such, it is not surprising that 81% of the targeted households fall between the “crisis” phase #3 and the “emergency” phase #4 of the widely recognized integrated phase classification (IPC).

90% of the assessed livelihood activities require low skills and are mainly situated in the informal sector: informal labor (seasonal agricultural work, construction work or housework services), agricultural production (mainly rice and cassava), wild picking and hunting, animal raising (mainly chicken), buying/producing and selling food, and/or collecting and recycling junk. The remaining 10% are formal wage labor (mainly in food shops, restaurants, hotels and garment factories), informal wage labor (taxi drivers and cart carrier) and other small entrepreneurship (beauty salon and handcraft).

While vulnerable households try to remain economically active amidst the economic downturn, reflecting their capacities to mitigate and/or adapt partly to the secondary impacts of COVID-19, they all still face a similar array of barriers that limits their ability to fully restore and/or develop alternative livelihood without external assistance.

Limited human capital, such as high levels of illiteracy and limited technical/budget management/business management skills coupled with insufficient financial capital (high levels of debts, important revenue loss, limited access to safety nets, limited capital/savings) impedes their capacity to acquire new skills and to invest in their current/prospective livelihood activities while meeting their essential needs. This situation is further exacerbated by the fact they hold very few productive assets they could leverage and have limited to no access to land they may utilize for complementary feeding and/or cash crop.

At the time of publishing this this report (April 2021), COVID-19 is rapidly spreading in Cambodia, which in turn has been forcing national authorities to impose restrictive measures on economic and social life, especially in the urban hot spots of Phnom Penh, Kandal and Siem Reap. As such, it is likely that these vulnerable households will fall further into poverty

and lose their few remaining resilience capacities with no hope for a rapid recovery if no substantial external assistance is provided in the medium to long-term.

The reports concludes with a set of program recommendations, including some here-below:

1. Propose multiple livelihood pathways with short-term prospects in both agricultural and non-agricultural sectors, according to households' preferences, the most promising activities, including in the green economy, and their capabilities to support the strengthening of existing livelihood activities or the development of alternative activities
2. Support the development of short production cycles to ensure rapid return on investments, such as domestic poultry, horticulture and cricket production
3. Support the development of innovative, low-tech, do-it-yourself soilless cultivation and animal raising technics notably for households with limited access to land and water, and in urban or semi-urban areas
4. Ensure the targeting of out-of-school youth while including "do no harm" approaches that prevents risks of child labor and that does not give further incentives for children to drop-out school
5. Provide financial literacy, basic business/budget management and marketing trainings to help households better plan and prioritize their incomes and needs and manage their activity
6. Ensure access to vocational trainings, notably for beauty salon, mechanics and food processing, while covering costs such as transportation, tuition fees, essential training material, accommodation, food etc.
7. Facilitate linkages with market actor/systems and the value chains through membership in Agricultural Cooperative/Producer Groups and/or access to improved processing technics
8. Ensure that the livelihood activities in disaster-prone areas are prepared and sensitive to climate change, including building staff capacities on emergency preparedness, determining the triggers to activate early action/financing, developing preparedness plans with communities and planning/delivering early actions while leveraging on social protection scheme
9. Ensure the provision of support services for post-graduation job/internship placement

Introduction

Background

Family Care First (FCF) is an initiative that seeks to uncover and advance transformational solutions that considerably reduce the number of children growing up outside of safe, nurturing family-based care.

FCF|REACT is a network of organizations working together to support children to live in safe, nurturing family-based care facilitated by Save the Children International (SCI). SCI works in collaboration with the government, local and international NGOs, academic institutions and UN agencies, to enhance and strengthen family-based care. Save the Children together with around 60 member organizations are working to prevent children from being separated from their families and increase the number of children that are safely and successfully integrated into family-based care. The intervention is done to strengthen systems and policies and to provide services to children and families directly.

The objectives of FCF Cambodia are to:

- Prevent unnecessary child-family separation
- Reduce the number of children living in orphanages and other residential care institutions
- Increase the number of children reintegrated into appropriate, protective, and permanent family-based care
- Reduce the number of orphanages and other residential care institutions

SCI provides funding to a number of partner organizations to implement direct activities to achieve these objectives, which includes direct service provision to children and families to strengthen family-based care for children and system level efforts to strengthen social work. To support and strengthen this work across the child protection sector, SCI facilitates the network to communicate and share knowledge, obtained through implementation and research, across the network to inform changes in implementation. SCI also works to ensure that the lead ministry, the Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth (MoSVY), takes a leadership role in FCF | REACT.

With the inclusion of EU funding during 2019, FCF has expanded and re-branded to include REACT. Family Care First | REACT are synergistic activities that contribute towards the same overarching goal of children in safe, nurturing family-based care. Members of FCF | REACT are all recognized in the same way.

The United State Agency for International Development (USAID) has granted SCI additional funding under the FCF | REACT program to support households in mitigating the secondary impacts of the COVID-19 pandemic. SCI has subsequently commenced interventions in the areas of child-sensitive livelihoods and social protection to complement the existing FCF | REACT program, whereby case management, counseling and support are provided to vulnerable children and families, who are at risk of separation or who have been placed in family based care.

Seven FCF| REACT partners are providing a child-sensitive cash transfer assistance between December 2020 and July 2021 to 702 households in situations of high economic insecurity

due to the impacts of COVID-19, in order to prevent them from resorting to negative coping strategies that could lead to increased child protection risks.

Objective

The livelihoods assessment will support the design of a child-sensitive livelihood assistance program to prompt livelihoods restoration and prevent, or reduce, the use of negative coping strategies, which are potentially harmful for children. The program will target the same vulnerable households receiving cash assistance, as outlined above.

Outline

This report outlines the main findings of the livelihood assessment as follows:
Section 1 provides an overview of the recent socio-economic developments in Cambodia and the socio-economic impacts of the COVID-19. **Section 2** provides an analysis of the capabilities of the FCF| REACT cash-eligible households. **Section 3** moves on with an analysis of the households' livelihood strategies and preferences as well as the barriers they face to restore/develop livelihood activities and to develop new skills. **Section 4** concludes with a series of programmatic options to feed the design of the child-sensitive livelihood assistance.

Methodology

SCI relied on a mixed methods approach to collect and analyze quantitative and qualitative data. Data-collection tools were designed by the FCF| REACT team.

A **secondary-data analysis** of livelihoods assessments completed in Cambodia since the beginning of COVID-19: an initial desk review was conducted in July 2020 by SCI Myanmar staff deployed to Cambodia for this purpose. Findings were consolidated with a complementary secondary-data analysis in January/February 2021. In total, 14 documents were consulted (see Annex 1 – Bibliography);

A **Household Economic Survey** (HES): a quantitative survey assessing households' socio-economic vulnerability and the secondary impacts of COVID-19. Seven FCF| REACT partners[1] carried out fieldwork in November 2020 in 17 Provinces[2] with 823 households at risk of separation or who have been reintegrated, who are receiving case management. 702 of the assessed households have been made eligible for the child-sensitive cash transfer support and may be targeted for the livelihood assistance (referred here under as the "targeted households") according to the operational capacities of implementing partners.

702
Targeted households

Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) to assess households' capabilities, their livelihood preferences, the barriers they may face to restore or develop alternative livelihoods and an analysis of roles and responsibilities within households: five FGDs were conducted remotely in February 2021 with 35 participants (20 women and 15 men) of the FCF| REACT partners,

491
Livelihood activities

[1] Cambodian Children Trust (CCT); Children's Future International (CFI); Komar Rikreay (KMR); Hagar Cambodia; This Life Cambodia (TLC); First Step Cambodia (FSC) and Safe Haven
[2] Battambang, Siem Reap, Phnom Penh, Banteay Meanchey, Kandal, Kampong Speu, Oddor Meanchey, Kampong Chhnang, Preah Vihear, Kampong Chhnang, Prey Veng, Takeo, Svay Rieng, Kampot, Tboung Khmum, Kampong Cham and Pursat

representing 491 livelihood activities undertaken by 302 of the cash-eligible households they provide case management to in 8 Provinces (see Annex 2 – FGD tool);

Key informant interviews (KII) were conducted in February/March 2021 with 14 training providers from the public and private sectors to assess the capacities of training providers and the barriers to access vocational trainings in the targeted locations (see Annex 3 – KII tool).

14
Training providers

Limitations

A labor market assessment was initially envisaged with both quantitative and qualitative data-collection at household and community levels. However, limited field resources, time constraints and restrictive COVID-19 measures limited SCI and Partners' ability to collect data at household, market and community-level. As such, it was not possible to assess the "demand" side of the labor market nor to identify the most promising economic sectors.

As such, the FCF| REACT team conducted FGDs with the social workers of FCF| REACT partners to assess trends in terms of socio-economic vulnerability and opportunities for their client caseload. Some of the below findings therefore reflect the perception of the social workers, whom have limited experience and expertise in the sector of livelihoods and early recovery.

The livelihood assessments carried out since the COVID-19 in Cambodia have a limited focus on the most vulnerable households and their cross-sectorial vulnerability. Many adopted a macro-level and/or sectorial lens or focused on a certain category of the population in a specific location, with overall findings sometimes difficult to extrapolate to the targeted households.

A majority of these assessments were completed in mid-2020, however the Household Economic Survey was implemented in November 2020. Therefore, these results may not be entirely comparable as the dynamics of the COVID-19 pandemic, as well as its impacts on households, have evolved over time.

The programmatic recommendations are based on the information collected as part of the livelihood assessment and should be further analyzed by partners when developing their project proposals.

Section 1 - Overview of the socio-economic situation of Cambodia

Cambodia's economic boom

Cambodia has made impressive gains for children across health, education, and protection. These improvements were strongly driven by Cambodia's impressive economic growth. From 1995 to 2017, Cambodia was the 6th fastest growing economy in the world, largely driven by garment exports, agriculture, and tourism. The poverty rate fell from 47.8% to 13.5%. Labor force participation has increased to approximately 84%, approximately 80% for women and 89% for men in 2017 (National Institute of Statistics, 2018). As a result, Cambodia's economy has shifted from low to middle-low income country, with the ambition of becoming a middle-income country by 2030.

#6
Fastest growing economy

A restructuring economy

The composition of the Cambodian economy has shifted dramatically over the last three decades. The share of agriculture in GDP declined from 45% in 1993 to 21% in 2019, while the share of industry (including construction) has nearly tripled. Small signs of diversification are emerging in the sector of agriculture beyond rice and into production of maize, vegetables, sugar, and palm oil. The **garment** industry's share has remained constant at around 17%. Garments were the first labor-intensive, export-manufacturing in Cambodia, as an array of foreign investors set up factories in and around the capital city of Phnom Penh. The share of the **construction** sector in GDP has doubled from 6% in 2011 to 13% in 2017. Within the service sector, **tourism** has seen a notable increase. According to the OECD, tourism's share of GDP has risen from 6.2% to 16.3% over 2010-17. However, compared to other countries in the region (Thailand and Vietnam), Cambodia's economic diversification lags (USAID, Oct 2020).

Population profile

Cambodia has one of the youngest populations worldwide, with 60% below the age of 25. 29% of Cambodians are 0-14 years of age, while two-thirds are of working age, 15-64 years. 28% of the overall labor force are between 15-24 years while 57% are between 15-34 years (National Institute of Statistics. 2018).

According to the literature, 5.8% of persons 25 years and older have a post-secondary education (4.1% of women and 7.8% of men). It is important to note that some gender gaps exist in Cambodia, with female completion rates slightly higher than those of males. This translates into significantly higher reading scores for girls, and higher retention levels for boys. 8% of students achieve the minimum level of proficiency in reading and 10% achieve the same in mathematics (SEDS 2017).

Chronic child poverty

Despite these nationwide accomplishments, a complex array of factors still prevents many children from reaching their full potential. Cambodia is still roughly 80% rural, and poverty remains high in these areas. Multidimensional poverty also remains high, with 45% of 19-year olds or younger living in poverty[3].

45%

of U19 live in poverty

On small-business continuity and closure

According to the literature, the main driver for the closure of small and medium-size businesses since COVID-19 (regardless if they are part of the formal or informal economy and regardless of the type of business) is the reduced demand that forced owners to shut down or reduce operations.

In May-July 2020, 11% of business owners were concerned that they would not be able to survive for more than six months, with a higher percentage for registered businesses compared to non-registered businesses. At the same period, a majority of owners of non-registered businesses, such as street vendors and tuk-tuk drivers, were confident they would survive the pandemic (for 77% and 71% of them respectively) (The Asia Foundation. May-July 2020).

[3] Save the Children international. USAID Concept Note. July 2020

On employment

Also according to the literature, COVID-19 had a greater impact on employment in urban areas compared to rural areas where the majority of those needing to change their occupation moved to alternative activities such as farming, hunting/fishing, caring for livestock, factory/construction work and/or other daily/seasonal forms of labor (UN. COVID-19 Socio-Economic Impact).

19% of urban households had at least one member who lost his/her job and 65% experienced changes in economic activities whereas it accounts for 12% and 53% respectively for the rural households. The latter are more exposed to temporary job losses due to intermittent pause in rural industries.

23% of the employees of the 997 small and medium-size enterprise taking part in a survey in mid-2020 had already been laid off as a result of COVID-19. Such phenomenon impacted slightly less non-registered businesses (The Asia Foundation. May-July 2020)

Section 2 - Households' Capabilities

In this section the socio-economic profile of the targeted households is analyzed, as well as the capabilities they have to undertake formal employment and/or have other informal sources of generating income. The focus is on understanding the households human capital, social capital, physical capital, financial capital and natural capital according to the sustainable livelihoods framework and based on the results of the focus group discussions undertaken with FCF|REACT partners' social workers. This section also analyzes the livelihood activities that households currently undertake as well as their preferences to strengthen existing or develop alternative livelihoods, in addition to understanding the main barriers households face.

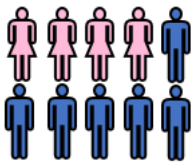
Human and social capitals

1. On targeting

All targeted households are at risk of separation or have children that have been reintegrated and are receiving child protection case management services by FCF|REACT partners. They were already in a situation of extreme vulnerability before the COVID-19 pandemic (SCI. Nov 2020) and are now all receiving a child-sensitive cash assistance by FCF|REACT partners.

2. On the head of household and roles and responsibilities

44% of the targeted households are headed by a woman (SCI. Nov 2020). The UN assessed that female headed households and small households experienced larger percentage of job losses (UN. COVID-19 Socio-Economic Impact).



The gender analysis carried out by SCI as part of the focus group discussions does not reveal strict divisions of roles and responsibilities between men and women for the management of the livelihood activities. The main difference noted is that women are more likely to be responsible for selling products at market level compared to men, and youth would support their parents when they have time outside school (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

3. On dependency

SCI calculated for each of the targeted households the ratio of young and old people who are not in work and are dependent on other members, also referred as the dependency ratio. In other words, the higher the ratio the more members depend on others for their subsistence and in turn exercise some form of pressure on the economic active member(s). The higher the ratio the more the household may be considered vulnerable.

$$\frac{\text{HH members U18 + HH members seniors}}{\text{HH members working age}}$$

While households are composed of 5 members on average in Cambodia, 11% of the targeted households have more than 3 dependent members, 45% have between 1.5 and 3 and the remaining 45% have less than 1.5 dependent member (SCI. Nov 2020). As such and as confirmed by FCF|REACT partners' social workers, households have on average one to two economically active members.

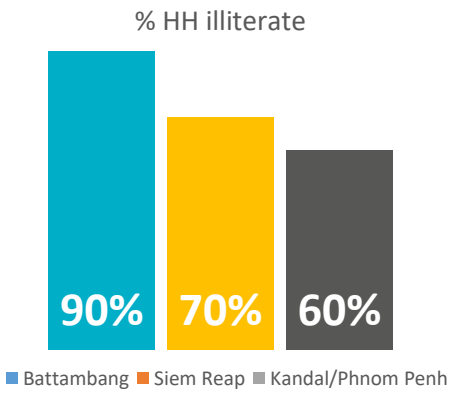
4. On members with special needs

67% have one member (33%) or more (34%) with disabilities and/or a chronic illness, inducing important health-related costs for the households and/or limiting the capacity of these members to fully engage in livelihood activities without external assistance (SCI. Nov 2020).

19% also have one member (16%) or more (3%) who is a pregnant or lactating woman with specific nutritional and health needs and 5% have one member or more who has contracted HIV/AIDs. Finally, 18% of targeted households have one member (10%) or more (8%) who returned from Thailand as a result of the COVID-19, exerting additional economic pressure on the households while removing incomes from remittances.

5. On literacy and formal education

The vast majority of the heads of the targeted households are considered illiterate according to social workers, with tangible variations across Provinces: up to 90% of the households in the Province of Battambang did not complete primary school (grade 6), against 70% in the Province of Siem Reap and 60% in the Provinces of Phnom Penh and Kandal.



6. On returning migrants

Although there is no precise figure, national authorities estimate that thousands of migrants returned from Thailand, exerting additional pressure on their household to cover for their essential needs, such as food, while inducing a loss of revenue from much needed remittances.

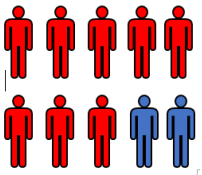
According to national authorities, returning migrants are mostly adults 25-34 years old with low to no labor skills. 57% have completed primary education, 26% secondary education and 10% have no formal education (MoSVY. April 2020).

18% of the targeted households have had least one member who returned from Thailand due to COVID-19 and 37% had planned to migrate again if the context allowed it (38% of them being located in the Province of Battambang and 52% in the Province of Siem Reap) (SCI. Nov 2020).

7. On food insecurity

Levels of exposure to food insecurity are higher for the already-vulnerable households compared to the rest of the population.

97% of the targeted households adopted severe strategies to cope with the lack of food, including adults eating less to ensure food for small children and/or having to borrow food, or rely on help from a friend or relative (SCI. Nov 2020).



81% of the targeted households fall between the "crisis" phase #3 and the "emergency" phase #4 of the widely recognized integrated phase classification (IPC) on food insecurity (SCI. Nov 2020).

These households are considered to be marginally able to meet minimum food needs but only by depleting essential livelihood assets or through crisis-coping strategies ("crisis" phase #3), or to be able to mitigate large food consumption gaps but only by employing emergency livelihood strategies and asset liquidation ("emergency" phase #4). 16% also fall in the "stress" phase #2 of the IPC, meaning that they have minimally adequate food consumption but are unable to afford some essential non-food expenditures without engaging in stress-coping strategies (SCI. Nov 2020);

In relation to the quantity and frequency of food intakes, 56% of the targeted beneficiaries reported facing moderate to severe levels of hunger (SCI. Nov 2020).

Some assessments highlighted that 70% of their respondents had decreased their food consumption - in some cases up to 50% (DCA. 2020) while others captured that 78% adopted emergency and/or crisis coping strategies due to the lack of food or money to buy food (UN/National Institute of Statistics. 2020).

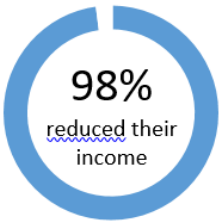
8. On economic groupings:

Although corporate associations exist in each target locations, such as motorbike associations or animal-raising associations (cow and pig), only a minority of the target households have taken membership (SCI.a. Feb 2021), limiting their linkage with other market actors and more generally with the local market system.

Financial capital

9. On incomes and financial inclusion

Loss of income is widespread: 98% of the targeted households experienced a reduction in income, with 22% losing all their revenues and 54% a majority of them.

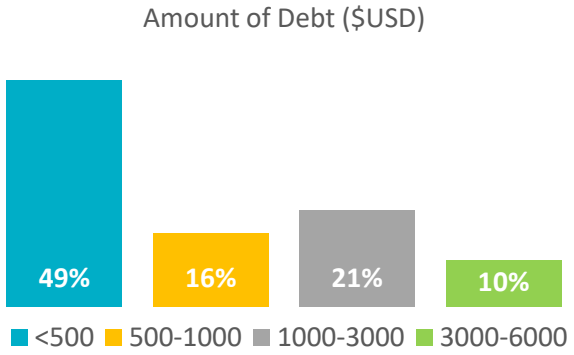


The main reasons (multiple answers option) for the loss of incomes are the loss of employment for 77% followed by the loss of business for 62%. Average revenues loss ranges from 183 USD to 315 USD per month (SCI. Nov 2020).

Formal and informal financial mechanisms are available with households accessing regular liquidities through banks such as ACLEDA, AMK, LOLC, PRASAC and AMRETH, micro-finance institutions such as SouSdey and Thoneakear Phnum and/or saving groups.

10. On debt:

76% of the targeted households contracted some debt as a result of COVID-19, with 49% taking up to 500 USD of debt, 16% between 500 USD and 1,000 USD and 31% taking 1,000 USD and over. 52% of those households expect not to be able to repay their debt without external support.



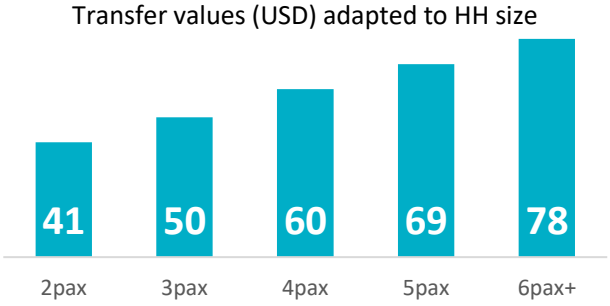
A majority (56%) contracted the debt from a private creditor charging approximately 10% interest rates per month which in turn may further exacerbate households' financial vulnerability and put them in a vicious circle of debt contraction and debt repayment. 19% relied on micro-finance institutions and 20% on other mechanisms (SCI. Nov 2020).

11. On social safety nets:

The Royal Government of Cambodia (RGC) expanded the coverage of the ID poor social safety net as a response to COVID-19. The Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth Rehabilitation (MoSVY) led five rounds of cash transfers since the beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic[4], the latest one benefiting up to 693,333 households and in overall totaling 291.98 million USD (MoSVY). Although 64% of the targeted households are registered into the social safety scheme (34% as ID poor – type 1 and 30% as ID poor – type 2), 9% of them had still not received any financial support from the RGC by the end of 2020 (SCI. Nov 2020).

At the time of publishing this report in April 2021 Cambodia faced a rapid spread of COVID-19, which forced the RGC to impose strict restrictive measures on the economic and social life and in turn to provide food support to the most vulnerable households located in "red zones" (considered as quarantined zones with no possibility of going out of homes for food purchases).

With USAID-financial support SCI and FCF|REACT partners also commenced implementation of child-sensitive social protection through the provision of monthly mobile money between December 2020 and July 2021 to all the households targeted for the child-sensitive livelihood assistance. Transfer values have been adapted to households' size, ranging from 41 USD to 78 USD.



[4] RGC introduced initial the measures in February to address potential impact of temporary lifting of Everything but Arms initiative by European Union and there were later expanded and accumulated due to severe impact of COVID-19 on various sectors and groups in the economy

Physical and natural capital

12. On productive assets

Very few of the target households hold productive assets. Those that hold assets are mainly limited to animals including approximately 10 to 20 chickens for the households not having received external assistance (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

Many households have a motorbike but with large variations between Provinces (up to 95% in Siem Reap compared to 45-50% in Battambang, Kandal and Phnom Penh Provinces). A small minority either have a car or nothing at all. Very few households have a water pump or a manual tractor. Seeds for vegetable growing are largely procured at market levels (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

13. On housing and access to land and utilities

The majority of the targeted households live in simple housing made of wood, zinc or other natural materials. A majority of the targeted households do not own land, which makes them vulnerable to potential risks of forced eviction. Average residential land is relatively small. Electricity is relatively accessible through connection to the public grid and/or by relying on solar panels. Reliable access to safe drinking water and water for agricultural production is much more limited with up to 80% of the households in some Provinces getting water from ponds and/or wells (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

Section 3 - Livelihood strategies and opportunities

Households' current livelihood activities

FCF|REACT partners' social workers participating in focus group discussions provided an analysis of 491 livelihood activities undertaken by 302 of the households[5] they represent, meaning that a majority has multiple sources of income.

90% of the livelihood activities require low skills and are mainly situated in the informal sector: informal labor (seasonal agricultural work, construction work or housework services), agricultural production (mainly rice and cassava), wild picking and hunting, animal raising (mainly chicken), buying/producing and selling food, and/or collecting and recycling junk (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

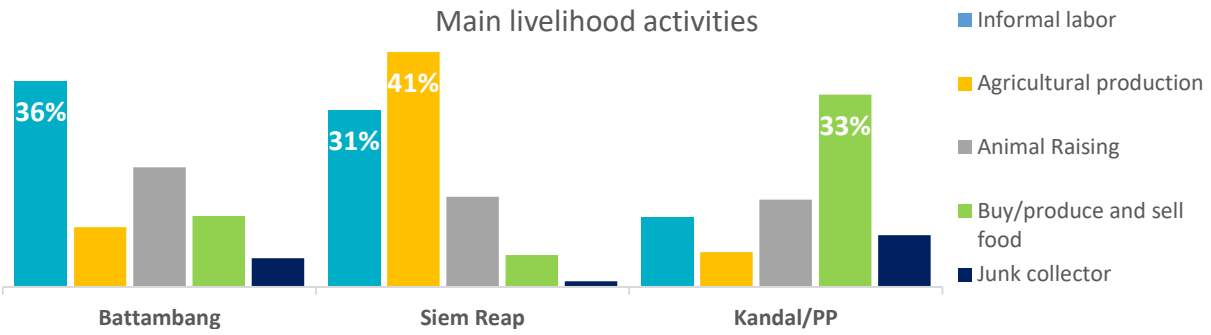
The remaining 10% are formal wage labor (mainly in food shops, restaurants, hotels and garment factories), informal wage labor (taxi drivers and cart carrier) and other small entrepreneurship (beauty salon and handcraft) (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

[5] 154 activities of 122 households in Battambang Province, 304 activities of 157 clients in Siem Reap Province, and 33 activities of 23 clients in Kandal and Phnom Penh Provinces

In the **Province of Battambang**, a large majority of the activities (33%) relates to unskilled and informal labor (seasonal agricultural work, construction work, housework services) while 21% is engaging in animal raising (mainly chicken raising and to a smaller extent cow and pig raising). Selling food at market level and horticultural production account for respectively 12% and 10% of the livelihoods activities.

In the **Province of Siem Reap**, a majority of the livelihood activities (41%) relates to agricultural production (mostly rice production followed by cassava, and horticulture to a much smaller extent). The second main core of activities relates to unskilled informal labor (31%). Noteworthy, 60% of the households are/were involved in some ways in the tourism and hospitality sectors.

In the Provinces of **Kandal and Phnom Penh**, a majority of the livelihood activities (33%) also relates to buying/producing food to sell at the market, followed by animal raising (15%).



Barriers to restore/strengthen existing livelihood activities

Targeted households face a similar array of barriers limiting their capacities to restore/strengthen their existing livelihood activities across Provinces and types of activities (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

The four main barriers are considered to be (1) the lack of capital to invest in or scale-up their existing livelihood activities, (2) the lack of inputs and assets, (3) the lack of budget management and basic business management skills, and (4) the lack of specific technical skills.

Limited market linkages is also considered an important obstacle preventing households to sell at market price while access to veterinary services impedes appropriate animal raising management.

Preferred vocational trainings

Across Provinces, FCF|REACT partners' social workers consider that the targeted households would be principally interested in vocational trainings in order to work in/set-up a beauty salon or become a hairdresser, to cook and sell food or to become a mechanic (car or motorbike).

Other favored vocational trainings according to FCF|REACT partners' social workers are animal raising (particularly chicken-raising), tailoring, and services in the hospitality sector. Other trainings include to a lesser extent horticulture, IT, electricity, business management and construction skills. Here below is a table presenting the preferred vocational trainings per Provinces[6] (SCI (a). Feb 2021):

Battambang	Siem Reap	Phnom Penh/Kandal
• Beauty salon/ hair-dreser	• Mechanics	• Beauty salon/ hair-dreser
• Cooking	• Horticulture	• Mechanics
• Tailoring	• Animal raising	• Cooking
• Mechanics	• Hospitality	• Hospitality

Barriers to access new skills

The impacts of the lack of formal education are further exacerbated by an array of barriers preventing households to develop technical skills. These barriers are similar across Provinces and are directly related to the specific socio-economic situation of the targeted households.

The lack of financial capital is considered to be the main barrier as it prevents households to cover for transportation costs, and tuition fees as well as accommodation and meal costs.

Another barrier is the depletion of the households' incomes when enrolling in a training, reflecting the limited number of sources of revenue for the targeted households as well as the number of economically active members (see above).

The lack of alternative child-care arrangements is also considered a barrier across Provinces, especially for women who act as the primary carer for children.

Other barriers such as the lack of information on training opportunities, the lack of material/assets and the absence of accommodation option prevent the targeted households from accessing such trainings (SCI (a). Feb 2021).

At the time of publishing this report in April 2021 Cambodia faced a rapid spread of COVID-19 forcing the RGC to impose strict restrictive measures on the economic and social life, as per decision 50 SSR of 14th April 2021. It notably led to the temporary closure of training

[6] This categorization reflect social workers' perception on the livelihood preferences of their client households. They are not the direct outcomes of a households consultation, as mentioned in the Methodology section, nor they take into account the needs on the "demand" side of the labor market;

centers as well as limitation for field work and group gatherings until 28th April and with high likelihood for extension.

Implementing partners of SCI Cambodia should take into account those considerations when designing their child-sensitive livelihood assistance.

Vocational training opportunities

This section presents the results of the mapping of 14 public and private training providers undertaken in the Provinces of Battambang, Siem Reap and Phnom Penh by SCI Cambodia as well as an analysis of the trainings they provide, their current resources and operation management, the extent of post-graduation follow-ups and their adaptation to evolving labor market dynamics. Contact details may be provided by SCI Cambodia upon request.

Implementing partners of SCI Cambodia are encouraged to also consider alternative training options considering the recent COVID-19 developments and the subsequent temporary closure of training centers.

In the Province of Battambang, key informant interviews have been carried out with 6 training providers: 3 Technical Vocational Education and Training centers (TVET), the Provincial Department of Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery (PDAFF), one social enterprise (Green Mango Cafe and Bakery and Culinary Training Center/Global Impact) and one NGO (Caritas Cambodia).

a. Battambang Institute of Technology (BIT)

Address: Rumchek village, Sangkat Rattanak, Krong Battambang, Battambang Province on a 12 Ha land
Contact person: Mr. Kann Srun, deputy director
Background: Set-up in 1964 as a training center and transformed into an Institute under the Ministry of Labor and Vocational Training (MoLVT) in 2007
Available trainings: Electric installation, Motorbike repairing, small engine repairing, air-conditioner repairing, computer service, sewing, horticulture. All curriculum include life-skill trainings too.
Duration: 4 months (short courses) up to 1 year
Costs: Free of charge (but $360/year for weekend trainings)
Target groups: Youth dropping-out school at grade 7, 8, 9 or 12
Requirements: Youth must complete a 186-hour skill-bridging course including mathematics, physics, chemistry and Khmer language as a condition to further continue the technical and vocational training (C1). Need to complete grade 9 or a skill-bridging course for C1-technical and vocational training; need to have high-school certificate or a letter to confirm completion of grade 12 or the same value certificate for high technology diploma and need to have high-school certificate for bachelor degree.
Operations management and support: three workshops are available to practice skills on electricity, air-conditioner mechanic and motor/car repairing; there is accommodation with utilities but limited to a 100 students.
Students and resource staff: In 2021, 740 students for 52 staff (10 women and 42 men). 500 students graduate each year
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: The Institute seek to facilitate job placement following training completion with private sector actors (garages, small and medium-size enterprises such as Kubota, Toyota, Ford, John Deer etc.).

Strengths: The Institute focus on the most vulnerable persons and seek to develop close collaboration with actors of the private sector to facilitate employability. There is no tuition fee and the center is located in the city of Battambang allowing supporting NGO to facilitate access to accommodation. The trainings mentioned above last 4 months.
Weaknesses: There is no training focusing on the agricultural sector. Only dropped-out youth grade 7/8 may be eligible for admission. Very limited accommodation arrangements within the Institute.

b. National Vocational Institute of Battambang (NVIB)

Address: Andong Pring village, Sangkat O'mal, Krong Battambang, Battambang province on a 6Ha land
Contact person: Mr. Pav Meng Heang, deputy director
Background: Created in 1998 under the name of Prey Kon Khla to train on pot and plate-making. MoLVT manages the Institute from 2005. It was renamed as the National Vocational Institute of Battambang in 2016
Available trainings: **(1) short-term trainings (5 to 7 days) provided at village level** and that include: animal-raising (chicken, pig, frog, eel including hatchery box development for chicken, quail and duck), horticulture (compost making, pesticide making and utilization), Mushroom growing, fruit/vegetable processing, cooking, and rice growing (seed selection, pesticide/fertilizer utilization); **(2) medium-term trainings (4 months)** include: building electrical wiring, motorbike and small engine repairing, welding, masonry, computer repairing, sewing and make-up
Duration: 5-7 days to 4 months for short courses; 1 year+ for long courses
Costs: Free of charge (but need to cover administrative cost (travel, meal, refreshment…etc.), if agriculture-related trainings are conducted at field-level)
Target groups: N/A
Requirements: To be able to write and read. A one-month internship is mandatory following completion of the 4-month training in order to graduate
Requirements: There is no restriction for registration in the 5/7-day course at field level. To be able to write and read for the 4month course. A one-month internship is mandatory following completion of the 4-month training in order to graduate. Need to complete grade 9 or skill bridging course for C1-level technical and vocational training; need to have a high-school certificate or a letter confirming completion of grade 12 or an equivalent certificate for high-technology diploma; need to have high school certificate for bachelor degree.
Operations management and support: three workshops are available to practice skills on car mechanic, electricity, construction as well as one processing unit for vegetables and fruits; there are accommodation with utilities but limited to a 200 students. Rice portions are provided to the most vulnerable students to limit risks of dropping-out
Students and resource staff: In 2021, 340 students[7] (80 girls/women and 260 boys/men) for 54 staff (16 women and 38 men). 300 students graduate each year for long-term course (one year or more), 400 for the 4-month course and another 400 students per year for the 5/7-day trainings.
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Phone-based follow-up. The Institute seek to facilitate internship placement with garages and small-size enterprises,
Strengths: The Institute does not restrict access and there is no tuition fee, with the possibility to enroll for short-term or medium-term trainings on a very broad array of topics, including agricultural and non-agricultural activities. It also possible to conduct training at field level

[7] It does not take into account those students enrolled in short-term trainings

(village/commune) for agricultural course. It collaborates with actors of the private sector to facilitate internship placement. The Institute appears collaborative and flexible with NGOs.
Weaknesses: The Institute is located outside the city of Battambang with limited accommodation options in the surrounding area

c. Regional Polytechnic Institute Techo Sen Battambang (RPITSB)

Address: Road 1, Prek Mohatep village, Sangkat Svaypor, Krong Battambang, Battambang Province
Contact persons: Mr. Hin La, Director of educational and vocational office; Mr. Khut Sokun, Acting Director of Administrative Office; Mr. Sok Sokhon, Deputy Director of Educational office and Mr. Kim Chanro, Deputy Director
Background: Created in 1993 with the support of the International Labor Organization (ILO) and transformed into an Institute in 2007 under MoLVT
Available trainings: (1) short-term trainings (5 to 7 days) provided at village level on the agricultural sector – those trainings are accessible for illiterate persons with 70% practice and 30% theory; (2) 4-month trainings provided at the Institute level on computer administration, database management, computer accounting, graphic design and printing, computer repairing, web development, web-network administrator, Internet and email, electricity, outfitting, make-up, agriculture, English, Chinese, Korean
Duration: 5-7 days to 4 months for short courses; 1 year+ for long courses
Costs: Free of charge (but need to cover administrative cost (travel, meal, refreshment…etc.), if agriculture-related trainings are conducted at field-level)
Target groups: N/A
Requirements: No admission requirement for 5/7-day courses. Need to be able to write and read for 4-month courses. Need to complete grade 9 or skill-bridging course for C1-level technical and vocational training. Need to have a high-school certificate or a letter confirming completion of grade 12 or a same value certificate for high technology diploma. Need to have a high-school certificate for bachelor degree.
Operations management and support: 3 workshops and one lab: electricity, electronic, car mechanic and food processing. There are accommodation with utilities but limited to a 100 students. The Job Center office, under the National Employment Agency (NEA) is located within the Institute.
Students and resource staff: In 2021, 1,113 students[8] (389 girls/women – or 35%) for 66 staff (11 women and 55 men). 371 student (78 women/girls) graduated in 2020 from long-term trainings and 1,000 students receive short-term training annually
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Phone-based follow-up. Support for post-graduation job hunting is provided, leveraging on the existence of the Job Center Office within the Institute's premises
Strengths: The Institute does not restrict access and there is no tuition fee, with the possibility to enroll for short-term or medium-term trainings on a very broad array of topics, including multiple options in the sector of IT. Short-term trainings may be provided directly at village level, removing some barriers to access trainings at Institute-level for vulnerable people. There are workshop areas within the Institute premises where students may practice and improve their skills. It collaborates with actors of the private sector to facilitate job placement.
Weaknesses: The Institute has limited accommodation options

[8] It does not take into account those students enrolled in 7-day trainings

d. Provincial Department of Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery (PDAFF)

Contact persons[9]: Mr. Khat Borin, Director of Agronomy Office; Mr. Prum Rith, Deputy Director of Planning Office and Mr. Tim Phean, Deputy Director of Veterinarian Office
Available trainings: All trainings are focusing on the agricultural sector and are adapted to the specific needs of the participants, from production to market linkages: rice, vegetable, animal raising, community forestry support and beekeeping
Costs: The implementing partner NGO must submit a training request highlighting coverage of the DSA, transportation and training fees to be covered. However, NGOs may negotiate the collaboration and budget provision with PDAFF.
Operations management and support: The PDAFF set-up Agriculture, Natural Resource and Environment Offices at provincial and district levels
Students and resource staff: 214 staff (57 women and 157 men), including 21 staff in the Agronomy Office and 30 staff in the Veterinary Office
Strengths: They have a track-record of collaboration with NGOs under the ASPIRE project, such as World Vision International-Cambodia, Voluntary Services Overseas (VSO) and CAVAC. They do direct implementation beyond the provision of trainings, notably the livelihood needs assessments at household-level, market linkages with medium-size agri-business actors, the provision of conditional grant and productive assets. They worked with more than 20,000 households between 2018 and 2021.
Weaknesses: With multiple internal layers of validation/communication/reporting some delays may be anticipated in the implementation and monitoring (all their subordinate staff at district level are under the leadership of the District Governor). DSA fee must be covered too.

e. Green Mango Cafe and Bakery and Culinary Training Center

Address: Nearby ABA bank in Krong Battambang, Battambang Province
Contact persons: Ms. Thav Vannarath, Director Associate and Ms. Ly Phalla, Director
Background: Green mango is a social enterprise registered at the Ministry of Commerce. It is a part of NGO called Center for Global Impact that have the office in Phnom Penh and Battambang province.
Available trainings: Western Food cooking, coffee making, cake baking, computer, English, Khmer, mathematics, life-skills, successful job, bible
Duration: 1.5 years
Costs: Free of charge with other additional support
Target groups: young women who are vulnerable to any abuses, person victim of labor abuse, youth dropping-out of school, poor households
Requirements: Selected students are referred to DoSVY and Green Mango conduct a home-visit to assess vulnerabilities
Operations management and support: Student get a lunch per day, a bike for transportation and some training material as well as a $10/week financial support and a start-up capital of $450/person (but need to pass all subjects)
Students and resource staff: 12-13 female students (16-22 years) come to study annually for 7 training staff (all women)
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Social worker follow up student and their families after completing the course.

Strengths: Green Mango provides life-skill and general knowledge to young ladies (theory and practice)
Weaknesses: Only a small number of students may be accepted. Training options mainly focus on the hospitality/tourism which may not be considered as promising sector for economic growth considering the current COVID-19 context

f. Friendly Vocational Skill Development Center (CARITAS Cambodia)

Address: Banan district, Battambang Province
Contact person: Mr. Phiroth, Project Manager
Available trainings: Beauty-salon, cooking, sewing, handicraft
Duration: 6 months
Costs: Free of charge
Target groups: Vulnerable girls and women 15-35 years old (widows, victims of abuse/violence, member of poor household, dropped-out of school/illiterate)
Requirements: Being a girl/woman
Operational management and support: Students can stay-over at the Caritas Training Center; Provision of one learning trip/year; student also learn from contracted private actors
Students and resource staff: Targeted 100 female students per year for nationwide with 10 staff/4 females
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Support on job hunting
Strengths: Vulnerable women can approach this center for temporary living and learning soft-skill/life-skill and vocational training skill
Weaknesses: Only a small number of students may be accepted

In the Province of Siem Reap, key informant interviews have been carried out with 5 training providers: 3 Technical Vocational Education and Training centers (TVET), the Provincial Department of Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery (PDAFF) and Dr. Motorbike, a training center managed by the FCF|REACT partner This Life Cambodia (TLC).

g. Siem Reap Provincial Department of Agriculture Forestry and Fishery (PDAFF)

Address: Beung Dounpa village, Sangkat Slagram, Krong Siem Reap, Siem Reap Province
Contact person: Ms. Sar Rene, Deputy Director
Background: Established in 1979
Available trainings: Fish raising, fish breeding and hatchery, frog raising, frog breeding, crocodile raising and breeding, rice growing, vegetable growing, home gardening, cassava growing and fruit tree planting, chicken raising, duck raising and cow raising
Duration: 1 to 2 full days
Costs: Need to cover DSA fee and transportation for facilitators/trainees as well as training material
Target groups: Community members, youth and out-of-school children
Requirements: N/A
Students and resource staff: Currently there are around 200 staffs working in the Department of Agriculture.

Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Follow-ups home visits are provided upon course completion to discuss the challenges they may face in the implementation of their new skills.
Strengths: Sufficient technical staff at Provincial and District levels with the capacity to conduct training and practice sessions at village/commune level and conduct follow-ups/ field monitoring visits
Weaknesses: Financial support is required for the provision of any kind of trainings. No accommodation.

h. Regional Polytechnic Institute Techo Sen Siem Reap (RPITSSR)

Address: Bantaychas Village, Sangkat Slagram, Krong Siem Reap, Siem Reap province
Contact person: Ms. Pang Puthy, Director
Background: Established in 1993 and managed by the International Labor Organization (ILO). In 2004, the center was transferred to the Ministry of Labor and Vocational Training and in 2014 the center became the Regional Polytechnic Institute Techo Sen Siem Reap
Available trainings: Agriculture courses, chicken/pig-raising, vegetable growing, post-harvesting management, disease control and vaccination. Non-agriculture courses: electronic, machinery, hair-dresser, air-conditioner repairing and wedding embellishment
Duration: 1 to 4 months
Costs: USD 250-300/student
Target groups: Community members, youth and out-of-school children
Requirements: Community members, youth and out-of-school children able to read and write
Students and resource staff: There are 80 staffs including 22 women. 884 students including 316 females have graduated from the Institute (including 40 persons with disabilities). There are 501 students including 202 females students currently enrolled.
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Field visit and phone call follow-ups
Strengths: Short courses available in both the agricultural and non-agricultural sectors
Weaknesses: Tuition fee is mandatory. Limited accommodation capacities

i. National Polytechnic Institute of Angkor (NPIA)

Address: Prey Koy Village, Ampil commune, Bakong district, Siem Reap province
Contact person: Mr. Hun Piseth, Deputy Director
Background: Established in 1992, and managed by the Provincial Department for Education, Youth and Sport. In 2005, the Institute was transfer under the Ministry of Labor and Vocational Training and Education.
Available trainings: Agricultural courses: chicken/pig/cricket/frog-raising, vegetable growing and rice growing. Non-agricultural courses: electronic, machinery, car/AC-repairing, welding and water connection
Duration: 1 week to 4 months
Costs: USD 250-350/student
Target groups: Community members, youth and out-of-school children
Requirements: Community members, youth and out-of-school children able to read and write
Students and resource staff: 45 full-time staffs (8 women) and 30 contract staffs (22 women). There are 2,600 students including 1,820 women who graduated. Currently, there are 480 students.

Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Field visit and phone call follow-ups. Support job placement by facilitating connection between graduated students and potential employers.
Strengths: Short courses available in both the agricultural and non-agricultural sectors.
Weaknesses: Tuition fee is mandatory. Limited accommodation capacities

j. Cambodia –Japan Friendship Technical Education Center (CJFTEC)

Address: Mondul III Village, Sangkat Slagram, Krong Siem Reap, Siem Reap province
Contact person: Mr. Somethear, Director
Background: Managed by the Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport since 2015
Available trainings: Agricultural courses: hydroponics, vegetable growing, mushroom growing, compost making and traditional pesticide making. Non-agricultural courses: making cake, yellow noodle, pickle, and refreshment
Duration: 1 week to 4 months
Costs: USD 250-350/student
Target groups: Community members, youth and out-of-school children
Requirements: Community members, youth and out-of-school children able to read and write
Students and resource staff: 5 full-time staff and 12 contract staff. There are 200 students including 140 women who graduated. Currently, there are 140 students, including 98 women
Post-graduation follow-up and market link age: Field visit and phone call follow-ups. Support job placement by facilitating connection between graduated students and potential employers
Strengths: Provision of short-term courses adapted to the local demand
Weaknesses: Tuition fee is mandatory. Limited accommodation capacities

k. Dr. Motorbike Center

Address: Vatbor Village, Sangkat Salakamreuk, Krong Siem Reap, Siem Reap province
Contact person: Ms. Sivhkeach Ly, Case Manager, This Life Cambodia (TLC)
Background: The Dr. Motorbike center has been established in 2015 and managed by This Life Cambodia (TLC)
Available trainings: Motorbike repairing
Duration: 8 – 12 months
Costs: USD 500/student
Target groups: Community members, youth and out-of-school children
Requirements: Community members, youth and out-of-school children able to read and write
Operations management and support: All administration cost are cover by TLC
Students and resource staff: 6 full-time staff including 1 woman. 96 students graduated and 31 men are currently enrolled
Post-graduation follow-up and market link age: Field visit and phone call follow-ups. Support job placement by facilitating connection between graduated students and potential employers
Strengths: Specialization in motorbike mechanics which is considered as a promising economic pathway for vulnerable households

Weaknesses: Tuition fee is mandatory. Limited accommodation capacities. No training options

In the Province of Phnom Penh, key informant interviews have been carried out with 3 Technical Vocational Education and Training centers (TVET): Industrial Technical Institute (ITI), the Cambodia-Thai Skill Development Institute (CTSDI) and the Cambodia-India Entrepreneurship Development Institute (CIEDI).

l. Industrial Technical Institute (ITI)

Address: Russian Burlova, Sangkat Teuk Thla, Russeykeo, Phnom Penh
Contact person: Mr. Heng Bunchhoeun, Deputy Director; Mr. Kung Dina; Deputy Director; Mr. Ouk Vireak, Deputy Director
Background: Vocational Training center set up in 1928
Available trainings: Electricity, Air-conditioner, mechanic, computer, welding
Duration: 4 months for vocational certificate or short course; one-year + courses
Costs: Free of charge ($300/year for evening class)
Target groups: Youth under 35 years old
Requirements: Be able to write and read for the 4-month course; have completed grade 9 or skill-bridging course for C1-level technical and vocational training; High-school certificate or letter confirming completion of grade 12 or the same value certificate for high technology diploma; need to have high school certificate for bachelor degree
Operations management and support: six labs/workshops are available to practice skills on electricity, air-conditioner, car mechanic, welding and lathe. There is accommodation with utilities. ADB project also support 20% of students with a monthly grant of $60/month.
Students and resource staff: In 2020, 700 students/4 females and119 staff/26 female. There are only 380 students had registered in 2021. 80% of students got scholarship from government.
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: The Institute seek to facilitate job placement following training completion with private sector actors (Ford, UME, Toyota, ETS, Tasaki… etc.).
Strengths: The Institute opens for youth under 35 years old and seek to develop close collaboration with actors of the private sector to facilitate employability. There is no tuition fee and the center is located in Phnom Penh city allowing supporting NGO to facilitate access to accommodation
Weaknesses: Very limited accommodation arrangements within the Institute.

m. Cambodia-Thai Skill Development Institute (CTSDI)

Address: Prey Popel village, Sangkat Samrong Krom, Khan Porsenchey, Phnom Penh
Contact person: Mr. Ros Beth, Director
Background: The Institute set up in 2002 by the Thai and Cambodian governments as vocational training center. The Institute became a TVET under the MoLVT in 2016
Available trainings: Electricity, air-conditioner, construction, welding
Duration: 4 months for vocational certificate or short course; one-year + courses (technical and vocational course, high technology diploma, bachelor of technology).

Costs: $500/year for bachelor degree, $300/year for high technical diploma and $50/year for C1, C2 and C3. However, in 2021, the Institute provided full scholarships to 400 students and 50% scholarship for male student and 60% to female student
Target groups: Youth
Requirements: Be able to write and read for the 4-month course; have completed grade 9 or skill-bridging course for C1-level technical and vocational training; High-school certificate or letter confirming completion of grade 12 or the same value certificate for high technology diploma; need to have high school certificate for bachelor degree
Operations management and support: Technical and material support provided by the Thai government. There is accommodation with utilities.
Students and resource staff: 1,000 students including 500 long-term student (one year or more). 78 staff/ 10 females.
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: The Institute seek to facilitate job placement following training completion. The Institute collaborates with handicraft companies and has signed MoUs with some of them, such as RMA, DVD…etc.
Strengths: The Institute is open to all youth with adequate technical and material support
Weaknesses: Very limited accommodation arrangements within the Institute (200 students)

n. Cambodia-India Entrepreneurship Development Institute (CIEDI)

Address: Russian Burlova, Sangkat Teuk Thla, SenSok, Phnom Penh.
Contact person: Mr. Mel Pho, Deputy Director
Background: Set up in 2006 and became an Institute in 2014. It changed its name to National Institute of Entrepreneurship and Innovation (NIEI) in 2019
Available trainings: For short course (4 months) and technical and vocational course: construction, air-conditioner, electricity, barista, cooking, beauty-salon; for High Technology Diploma, Bachelor and Master Degree: Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Business, Foreign language, IT and telecommunication, Technical Engineering
Duration: 4 months for vocational certificate or short course; One-year + courses (Technical and vocational course, high technology diploma, Bachelor and Master degree)
Costs: Free of charge
Target groups: Youth
Requirements: Be able to write and read for the 4-month course; have completed grade 9 or skill-bridging course for C1-level technical and vocational training; High-school certificate or letter confirming completion of grade 12 or the same value certificate for high technology diploma; need to have high school certificate for bachelor degree
Operations management and support: 2 workshops for electricity, 2 workshops for air-conditioner and other courses; students can practice in the compound.
Students and resource staff: 4,000 students for all courses and 1,200 students for registration each year including 60% of student join short-course. 119 staff.
Post-graduation follow-up and market linkage: Facilitate job placement following training completion. It collaborates with 39 industrial companies for job placement.
Strengths: The Institute is open for all youth and collaborates with some NGOs such as World Vision International-Cambodia, Swiss Contact as well as the World Bank and some companies. Conduct market assessment to identify the demand from companies and set up MoU with relevant companies for internship placements
Weaknesses: Very limited accommodation arrangements within the Institute, but it is in constructing process and it will available for 800 student to stay.

Section 4 - Programmatic recommendations

General Recommendations

1. Propose multiple livelihood pathways with short-term prospects in both agricultural and non-agricultural sectors, according to households' preferences, the most promising activities, including in the green economy, and their capabilities to support the strengthening of existing livelihood activities or the development of alternative activities
2. Ensure the targeting of out-of-school youth while including "do no harm" approaches that prevents risks of child labor and that does not give further incentives for children to drop-out school
3. Ensure effective coordination with FCF|REACT partners in charge of case management, including for the registration of household's members
4. Support the development of short production cycles to ensure rapid return on investments, such as domestic poultry, horticulture and cricket production[10]
5. Support the development of innovative, low-tech, do-it-yourself soilless cultivation and animal raising technics notably for households with limited access to land and water, and in urban or semi-urban areas
6. Take into account the cropping calendar and fisheries cycles

Financial inclusion and safety nets

7. Deliver conditional cash grants through the mobile money system already developed by SCI Cambodia as part of the child-sensitive cash assistance
8. Advocate toward the MoSVY for inclusion of the targeted households not already registered into the ID poor social safety scheme
9. Negotiate the terms of debt repayment with private creditors and micro-finance institutions

Skill development

10. Provide life-skill trainings to promote self-esteem and child care best practices
11. Provide financial literacy, basic business/budget management and marketing trainings to help households better plan and prioritize their incomes and needs and manage their activity
12. Ensure access to vocational trainings, notably for beauty salon, mechanics and food processing, while covering costs such as transportation, tuition fees, essential training material, accommodation, food etc.
13. Identify alternative training options in the event of the temporary closure of training providers due to COVID-19, including online trainings and the recording/broadcasting of training videos
14. Ensure the availability of alternative childcare arrangements to facilitate access to trainings

[10] Cricket raising may provide nutritional food sources while at the same time serving as an alternative livelihoods. Board cricket raising pens that are solar powered may prove energy and time efficient, providing consistent year round yield and harvest with limited workload. A double-pens kit connected to grid power may cost approximately 580USD and generate 117USD of gross revenue per 9-month cycle in Cambodia (Cricket House. 2021)

15. Conduct sensitization on infant and young child feeding best practices, nutritional diversity as well as hygiene

Market linkages

16. Ensure the provision of support services for post-graduation job/internship placement
17. Facilitate linkages with market actor/systems and the value chains through membership in Agricultural Cooperative/Producer Groups and/or access to improved processing technics

Climate-sensitiveness

18. Ensure that the livelihood activities in disaster-prone areas are prepared and sensitive to climate change, including building staff capacities on emergency preparedness, determining the triggers to activate early action/financing, developing preparedness plans with communities and planning/delivering early actions while leveraging on social protection scheme

Annex

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Annex 2 – Focus Group Discussion Tool

Date of FGD:	
Province covered:	
Represented partners:	
FGD Facilitator:	
FGD note taker:	

1. Guide for FGD facilitators

Please explain to social workers that the objective of this focus group discussion is to understand, from their perspective, the capabilities of their client households, their livelihood preferences as well as the barriers they may face to restore or develop alternative livelihoods. The last questions will relate to the situation of out-of-school youth as well as to gender considerations within the household.

Remind social workers the definition of livelihood: the capabilities, assets, incomes and activities required for a means of living.

The responses will feed the design of a child-sensitive livelihoods assistance to provide to some of the cash-eligible households affected by COVID-19. The discussion will take approximately 01 hour. We encourage every social worker to participate as much as possible so that we may have the most precise livelihood analysis and to provide the most relevant services to selected households.

Your participation in this focus group discussion does not mean that your client households will receive the livelihood assistance. It is not my decision to select or not select household to receive the livelihood assistance.

2. FGD PARTICIPANTS PROFILES

#	Organization	Position	Sexe (F/M)	Approximate number of clients in charge	Clients location (district)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
			Total		

3. CLIENTS' LIVELIHOOD PROFILE (Offer-side of the labor market)

Recall what a livelihood activity is (Ex: in agricultural group, rice cultivation is the livelihood activity).

Proceed with the below question for each sector of activity and by asking to each individual participant:

3.1. What are the main three livelihood activities each of your clients are engaging on?

Sector	Livelihood activity	Approximate # of SW's clients
Agriculture	**Livelihood activity** :_____	
	Livelihood activity:_____	
	Livelihood activity:_____	
Non-agriculture	**Livelihood activity**:_____	
Small-entrepreneurs	**Livelihood activity**:_____	
Informal wage-labor	**Livelihood activity**:_____	
Formal wage-labor	**Livelihood activity**:_____	

4. MAIN BARRIERS TO RESTORE OR DEVELOP ALTERNATIVE LIVELIHOODS

Explain to social workers you will now ask them about the main barriers their clients face to restore/strengthen an activity they already have. Respondents may provide as many barriers and mitigation measures as they want. Move on if they are not able to provide an answer.

4.1. For each livelihood activity, what would be the main barriers to restore or strengthen the activity and what could be the mitigation measures?

Livelihood Activity	Main Barriers to restore/strengthen activity	Mitigation Measures
Livelihood activity:_____		

Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		

Explain to social workers you will now ask them about the main barriers their clients face to develop alternative activities. Respondents may provide as many barriers and mitigation measures as they want. Move on if they are not able to provide an answer.

4.2. For each livelihood activity, what would be the main barriers to develop alternative activities and what could be the mitigation measures?

Livelihood A	Main barriers to develop alternative activities	Mitigation Measures
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		
Livelihood activity:_____		

Recall the definition of capital (what people have) and then go-through each form of capital. Give example of capitals before asking the relevant question.

Give example of human capital: level of education, skills and competencies, literacy rate, # labor force per household etc.

4.3. What is the human capital of your clients?

Description of the human capital

Give example of social capital: integration in society, extended family and other social networks, support from institutions, associations/NGOs etc.

4.4. What is the social capital of your clients?

Description of the social capital

Give example of financial capital: income sources, savings, access to loans etc.

4.5. What is the financial capital of your clients?

Description of the financial capital

Give example of physical capital: livestock, productive assets (car for taxi, machinery etc.), road connectivity, access to water and electricity, housing/shelter etc.

4.6. What is the physical capital of your clients?

Description of the physical capital

Give examples of natural capital: soil, water, air, genetic resources: type of vegetable, fruit crops

4.7. What is the natural capital of your clients?

Description of the natural capital

5. GENDER ROLES

5.1. Among your clients, what are the main roles related to livelihoods of:

MEN	WOMEN	YOUTH

6. OUT OF SCHOOL YOUTH

6.1. Generally, what are the 03 prioritized activities that the OSY engaged in NOW?

For OSY Boys	
For OSY Girls	
For OSY PWD	

7. VIII. VOCATIONAL TRAININGS

7.1. Are your clients aware or have heard of vocational courses or vocational schools? What do you think is their perception on the advantages and disadvantages of enrolling in such vocational courses/schools?

Perceived advantages of vocational courses/schools	Perceived disadvantages of vocational courses/schools

7.2. Do you think your clients would be interested in enrolling in vocational courses ? What would be the main barriers preventing them from accessing these courses ? How could these challenges be mitigated?

	Interests in vocational trainings	Challenges to access vocational trainings	Mitigation measure
OSY girls			
OSY Boys			
Women			
Men			

7.3. What other suggestions you can give to support the youth to become productive members of community?

7.4. Can you identify any organizations providing livelihood support to the youth in your area?

8. WRAPPING UP

Facilitator: to wrap up the discussion by going through the major discussion and highlighting the answers from the social workers.

Thank you.

Annex 3 – Key informant interview Tool – public and private training provider

Key Informant Interview with training providers – TVET

Date of Kii	
Province covered	
Training provider address	
Kii Facilitator	
Observing partners	

Guide for KII facilitators

*My name is Mr. /Ms. **XXX,** I am from Save the Children International in Cambodia and I wish to thank you for your time and for allowing us to meet you.*

Save the Children International in Cambodia is leading the coordination of the Family-Care First Program (FCF) funded by USAID and the European Union to prevent risks of family separation, facilitate children's reintegration into their families or in alternative family-based care and to support the Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth Rehabilitation (MoSVY) in strengthening its systems and policies.

Save the Children International in Cambodia has received an additional grant from USAID to coordinate a child-sensitive livelihood assistance program to mitigate the economic impacts of COVID-19 on vulnerable families and prevent the adoption of negative coping strategies detrimental to their children. The livelihood support is to complement the provision of case management services by our Partners.
The objective of this semi-structured interview is to assess the training curriculum the TVET may provide, the target audience as well as the opportunities and barriers to access such trainings.

The discussion will take approximately 01 hour and 30 minutes. We encourage you to provide as detailed information as possible so that we may have the most precise analysis of the opportunity to refer project's beneficiaries to the TVET.

Your participation in this semi-structured interview does not mean that the TVET will be selected for the livelihood assistance. It is not my decision to select or not select the TVET.

I. Overall background of the training center

1. Name, Position of respondents
2. How long has your center been established for? Got registration from whom?
3. How many staff do you have? Female?
4. How many student are currently studying in this center (male and female?)
5. How many students graduated from the center (male and female?)

II. Available course and requirement

6. What does your center do?

7. What are your current activities and who are your target beneficiaries? (Please provide detailed information if the organization is offering vocational courses).
   a) What vocational courses/other courses are you offering?
   b) What were the reasons or objectives why these courses were selected?
   c) When do you offer these courses? (schedule)
   d) What is the duration of each training?
   e) How do you select your attendees? (selection criteria/requirements)
   f) Do you require some form of contribution from the students?
   g) What courses you offer specifically for women/girls?
   h) What courses you offer specifically for PWD youth?

III. On resource persons/teachers for the courses

8. Who are your resource persons/teachers for the courses? (background/expertise)

9. What is your criteria for selecting the resource persons/teachers?

10. How much do you pay them and what terms? (per day? Weekly? Monthly?)

IV. Institution/center operation

11. What support services does your center provide to attendees (accommodation, meal…)?
    a. Is there a possibility for overnight stay in your centre ?

12. How do you maintain the centre in terms of operational costs and maintenance?

13. What are the usual challenges/problems when implementing vocational courses?

14. How do you mitigate these problems?

V. Follow up on graduated students

15. Do you provide support after they completed the course? Can you elaborate?

16. Do you monitor them after they complete the course? HOW?

17. Have they applied the courses they learned? HOW? Benefit?

18. What are the problems/challenges participants face now?

VI. Market Overview

19. Per your observation, what labor demands are on the rise? Why?
20. What labor demands are declining? Why?

Key Informant Interview with training providers – private sector

Introduction:
*My name is Mr. /Ms. **XXX,** I am from Save the Children International in Cambodia and I wish to thank you for your time and for allowing us to meet you.*

Save the Children International in Cambodia is leading the coordination of the Family-Care First Program (FCF) funded by USAID and the European Union to prevent risks of family separation, facilitate children's reintegration into their families or in alternative family-based care and to support the Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth Rehabilitation (MoSVY) in strengthening its systems and policies.

Save the Children International in Cambodia has received an additional grant from USAID to coordinate a child-sensitive livelihood assistance program to mitigate the economic impacts of COVID-19 on vulnerable families and prevent the adoption of negative coping strategies detrimental to their children. The livelihood support is to complement the provision of case management services by our Partners.

The objective of this semi-structured interview is to assess the training curriculum the TVET may provide, the target audience as well as the opportunities and barriers to access such trainings.

The discussion will take approximately 01 hour and 30 minutes. We encourage you to provide as detailed information as possible so that we may have the most precise analysis of the opportunity to refer project's beneficiaries to the TVET.

Your participation in this semi-structured interview does not mean that the TVET will be selected for the livelihood assistance. It is not my decision to select or not select the TVET.

I. Overall background of the private training provider

1. Name, Position of respondents
2. How long have you been delivering trainings for?
3. How many staff do you have? Female?
4. How many people are you currently training?

II. Available course and requirement

5. Who are your target clients?
6. What trainings are you offering
    a. What is the duration of each kind of training?
    b. How many participants do you accept for each kind of training?
    c. How much is the fee for each kind of training?
    d. What courses you offer specifically for women/girls?

e. What courses you offer specifically for PWD youth?

III. On resource persons/teachers for the courses

7. Who are your resource persons/teachers for the training? (background/expertise)

8. What is your criteria for selecting the resource persons/teachers?

9. How much do you pay them and what terms? (per day? Weekly? Monthly?)

IV. Institution/center operation

10. What support services do you provide to training participants (accommodation, meal…)?
    a. Is there a possibility for overnight stay in your facility ?

11. What are the usual challenges/problems when providing trainins?

12. How do you mitigate these problems?

V. Follow-up on training participants

13. Do you provide support after participants completed the course? Can you elaborate?

14. Do you monitor participants after they complete the course? HOW?

15. Have participants applied the courses they learned? HOW? Benefit?

16. What are the problems/challenges participants face now?

VI. Market Overview

17. Per your observation, what labor demands are on the rise? Why?

18. Per your observation, what labor demands are declining? Why?

19. Per your observation, what business sector is growing? Why?

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